Having served in the northeast for over twelve years, I have a fairly good understanding of the region. It has been plagued by a large number of secessionist or militant movements since independence, starting with Z.A. Phizo's call for independence for Nagaland in the 1950s. Initially, when the army was called to restore law and order, it adopted the 'scorched earth' policy and tried to suppress the insurgency with force. It was trained for conventional warfare and was new to counterinsurgency tactics. After making mistakes that antagonized a large part of the population and not achieving much success, it realized its folly. As a result, the Counter Insurgency and Jungle Warfare School was created in 1966–67 at Vairangte, to train the Indian Army units and junior leaders before their induction into insurgency-prone areas of the northeast. The Naga insurgency is the mother of all armed secessionist movements there. The high point of my experiences in the late 1960s was when we caught self-styled General Mowu Angami and a large number of rebels of his group who had just returned from China. It was the first major setback to the decade-old insurgency at that point and has been covered earlier in Part II. The pressure put on the underground by effective and professionally conducted counterinsurgency operations by the army resulted in containing the insurgents and winning the hearts and minds of the Nagas to some extent. The next major development was the change of heart of a group of about 1500 underground members of the 'Revolutionary Government of Nagaland' led by Scato Swu and the self-styled General Zuheto Sema. They had asked for a peaceful settlement within the Indian Union with some conditions. 16 August 1973 is the historical day when the ceremonial handing over of their arms to Governor B.K. Nehru took place at Zunheboto, the heartland of the Sema tribe. On that occasion, Scato Swu said, 'I would once again sincerely appeal to those who continue to mislead the people to totally give up the cult of violence and join us in our march forward to make Nagaland a modern and progressive state in our Great Country.'[7] Most of the surrendered cadres were rehabilitated in a battalion of Border Security Force under the command of Zuheto Sema and other police